



Difference between a normal website and AMP

that creates AMP pages, does so in addition to original ones, which increases server cost and energy usage, so it is a double-edge sword.

- **Data Centre Proximity** – A data centre that is close to the target audience will help reduce the energy data requires to travel through the telecom networks. Data centres already consume a hefty amount of energy and this step shall be beneficial to the planet.

ENERGY EFFICIENT INDIVIDUAL

Your daily activity in the digital world might be of negligible consequence to the planet. Multiply that with every person on the internet, and you will have a fair idea of the amount of emissions we can cut down collectively.

To give you an idea, 60 seconds in the digital world means almost 3.5 million videos watched on YouTube, close to 200 million e-mails sent, 4 million Google searches, and about a million hours of video streamed on Netflix!

Every action will have a far greater impact. Here is a look at what we can do to reduce our daily carbon footprint.

- **Inbox cleaning** – Delete or archive e-mails that you do not need anymore, files that were shared with you on the mail, and promotional e-mails. E-mails that sit in your inbox and also in data centres require enormous amounts of energy. “According to Orange, if every single person in France

deleted 50 e-mails, the energy savings would be equivalent to turning the Eiffel tower’s lights off for 42 years, or to New York City not consuming any electricity for 4 hours”, Reset.org

- **Unsubscribe from what you don’t read** – Removing newsletters that stack up in your inbox, that you don’t even read, is the next step after inbox cleaning. Every mail has attached to it an invisible amount of CO₂ emission.
- **Don’t reply all** – Every sent mail is a source of emission, sort and choose if everyone on the list needs the information you are sending out.
- **Reduce Streaming** – Video and audio streaming consumes massive energy and is responsible for tremendous CO₂ emissions arising from the digital world. Wherever possible, download the content instead of streaming it.
- **Bookmark it** – Every time you search for a website, the data centres go into overdrive to look for information. Bookmark the websites you visit often.
- **Turn off navigation** – Today, getting places is not a problem thanks to navigation facilities available on almost every digital device. However, turning navigation off where possible and actually finding a place on your own reduces emission!
- **Turn off autoplay** – Autoplay keeps the video loop on and as already mentioned, videos use a lot of energy. Turn it off when possible.
- **Cancel cloud storage** – Moving away from the cloud for the storage of data or regular cleaning of cloud data is an effective way to reduce emissions. Cloud providers such as Google, Apple, Salesforce, and Rackspace have all committed to data centres that will be powered by renewable sources of energy in the future. But till then, the hard disk of your computer does the job.
- **Transferring files** – Transfer files with USB sticks or services such as WeTransfer (they delete the file after 7 days from their data centres) instead of the cloud or messenger that stays on forever unless manually deleted.

- **Inactive tabs** – Close inactive tabs since every tab consumes energy.

HEALTHY HABITS WITH DEVICES

- **Unplug when charged** – Charging devices overnight is just a rabid waste of energy as every time the device drops below full charge the charging kicks back. It is harmful to your device’s battery and the planet.
- **Wi-Fi** – Use Wi-Fi instead of 4G networks wherever possible to reduce energy consumption by almost twenty times. Base stations have to overwork for high speed 4G networks or 5G in the future.
- **Shut down a device** – When not in use, shut down your device. Avoid putting them on sleep mode, if possible. Sleep mode or standby mode still uses up energy.
- **Recycle and reuse** – Certain components of your electronic devices can be reused. If returned to the



Electronic devices need proper recycling or disposal due to presence of toxins
(Michael Conroy / AP)

producer, that component can be recycled and refurbished. Don’t let it sit in your drawer, give it back!

- **Screen time** – Set a screen time for everyday activities. Don’t abuse screen time since it is beneficial to both you and Earth. Everything we do on our screens has implications for energy usage.

With the internet penetrating further than ever, there will, undoubtedly, be a greater need for energy in the sustenance of the digital world. While we all sit on our e-mails, watch the latest episode of Better Call Saul, and admire the most beautiful websites on the internet, we need to remember that every consumption comes with a tax of CO₂ emission. The further we can reduce it, the better it gets for the planet. One step at a time now will act like a butterfly effect for the future!